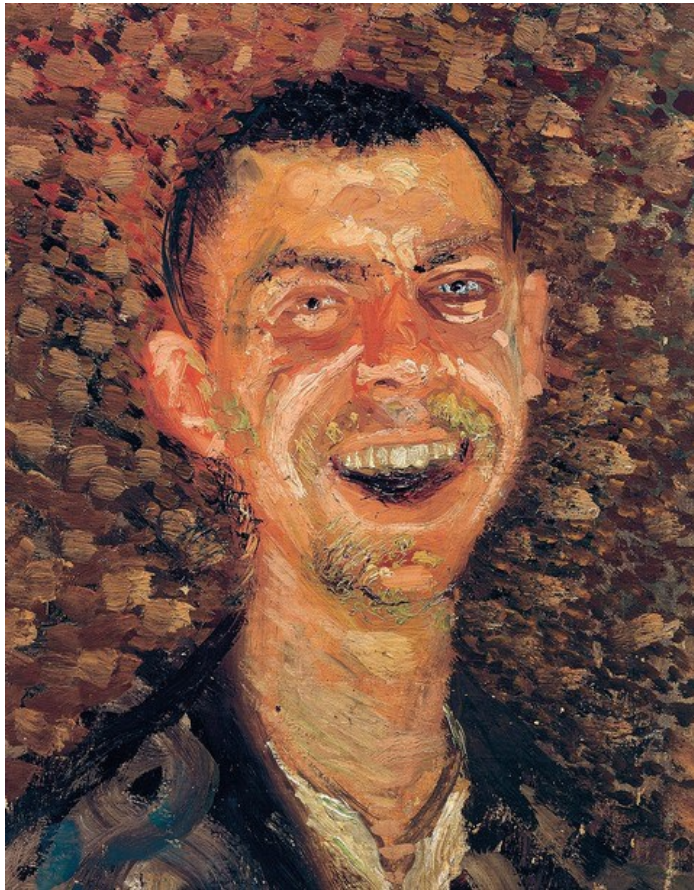


Classicism. From 1921, his invention of the 12-tone method of composition (see box) restored structural solidity after the instinctual anarchy of atonal writing: yet the result was music that was even more impenetrable to the public. It was typical of his conservative radicalism that the movements of his first complete 12-tone work, the Suite for Piano, Op. 25, were given titles such as Gavotte and Gigue that might have been used by Bach. In 1923, his wife Mathilde died, but he remarried, and had three children with his second wife, Gertrud Kolisch. His financial woes ended in 1926, when he began teaching composition at the Prussian Academy of Arts in Berlin.



GERSTL SELF-PORTRAIT, 1907

Richard Gerstl's close relationship with Schoenberg and his tragic affair with the